The After-Medicaid-Approval Checklist

What to save, write down and ask now that Mom has been approved.

Mom's Medicaid was approved. The letter is on the kitchen counter, and nobody has said what the family does next. These are the things to save, write down and ask about from here. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is something still to pull together or ask, not a sign that anything is wrong.

Save

- [ ] The approval notice itself, every page, in a folder more than one person in the family can find.
- [ ] Every later letter from the Medicaid agency, opened and kept in the same folder in date order. [1]
- [ ] A copy of anything the family sends to the agency, with the date it went and how it was sent.
- [ ] Mom's bank and other account statements as they arrive, and her legal and financial papers, kept where you can name the place.

Write down

- [ ] The dates printed in the approval notice, copied as written, including the effective date it gives.
- [ ] Any renewal date a letter mentions, on a calendar with a reminder. If no letter mentions one, write “renewal date not found”.
- [ ] Anything a letter asks the family to do or send, in the letter's own words, with any date it gives.
- [ ] What has changed since the application: Mom's income, her accounts and what she owns, where she lives, her care setting, her marital status. Write what changed and when, and leave what it means for later.
- [ ] Any money that has arrived or is expected outside her usual income, such as an inheritance, a gift, or proceeds from a sale or an insurance policy. Write what it is and when it came.

Ask

- [ ] The Medicaid agency or your Medicaid planner: what the approval notice says the family needs to keep doing, and whether it describes any ongoing payment or other obligation.
- [ ] Which kinds of changes the agency needs to hear about for Mom, how to tell them, and where that is written down.
- [ ] How renewal works for Mom: what the agency sends, and what the family might be asked for.
- [ ] Whether the agency has the right mailing address and phone number for letters about Mom, and how to update them. [1]
- [ ] Who looks at a large financial step involving Mom's money or property, such as a gift, a transfer or a sale, before it happens. That is a question for your Medicaid planner, and for an elder law attorney where it is a legal one.

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you save, write down and ask. It doesn't say what any letter means, which changes have to be reported, or whether anything affects Mom's Medicaid. Renewal, reporting and recordkeeping requirements vary by state and by case, so those answers come from the Medicaid agency's own notices and from a professional who knows your state's rules. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've saved the letters, written down the dates and lined up what to ask. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 follow the federal renewal flyer for people with Medicaid, which says to watch the mail and keep contact information current; the rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS), Have Medicaid or CHIP? Get ready to renew your coverage